and footer, as shown in figure 17.9. Also, each page in your application will probably reference the same CSS and JavaScript files.

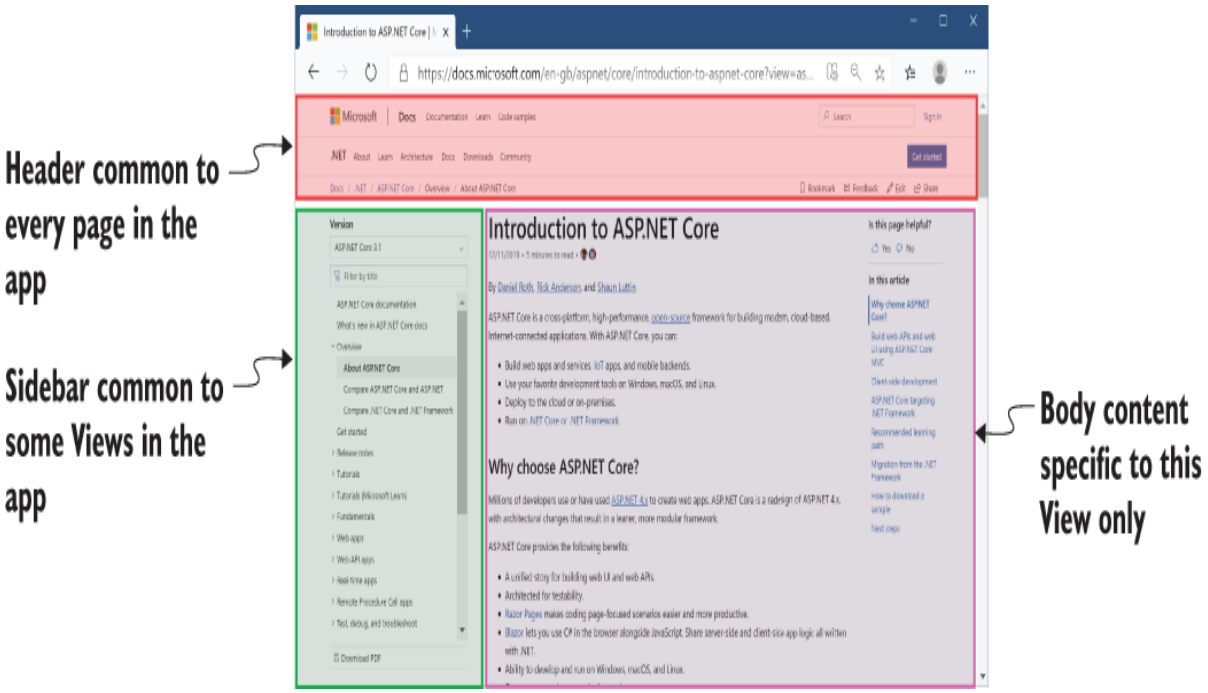


Figure 17.9 A typical web application has a block-based layout, where some blocks are common to every page of your application. The header block will likely be identical across your whole application, but the sidebar may be identical only for the pages in one section. The body content will differ for every page in your application.

All these different elements add up to a maintenance nightmare. If you had to include these manually in every view, making any changes would be a laborious, error-prone process involving editing every page. Instead, Razor lets you extract these common elements into *layouts*.

DEFINITION A *layout* in Razor is a template that includes common code. It can't be rendered directly, but it can be rendered in conjunction with normal Razor views.